

Task 3: Evaluation and Reflection

1. Self-Evaluation

During the redevelopment of my MCAST website, I made several changes that improved both the appearance and usability of the final solution. The earlier version was very simple, containing a small top bar, the MCAST logo, two main cards and a single campus image. In addition, the colour scheme did not closely match MCAST's existing branding. In the redeveloped version, I improved the navigation toolbar by providing clear links to **Home, Contact Us and Articles**. I also added a hero image to the homepage to make it feel more welcoming, included more informative content, introduced call-to-action buttons such as access to the MCAST Catalogue, and created a footer containing social-media and contact links. The strongest areas of the final website are the clearer navigation, improved visual hierarchy and more organised content, which make the website easier to understand and use.

My decisions were also influenced by user feedback gathered earlier in the project, which identified the need for clearer navigation, better accessibility, an improved layout and greater use of images. I responded to this feedback by introducing a consistent MCAST-inspired navy colour scheme, clearer page sections and additional relevant imagery. The consistent navigation also helps users understand where important links are located when moving between different pages.

The **Contact page** was significantly improved. To make the information more organised, I used tables to separate contact details for different departments and institutes. This allows users to scan the information more easily and locate the appropriate contact details more quickly. I also created a contact form using the `mailto:` attribute. The contact form allows users to prepare an enquiry that can be sent through their configured email application.

Testing was carried out after completing the redevelopment. I checked my HTML and CSS using the **W3C Markup Validation Service** and **W3C CSS Validation Service** and corrected the issues identified during validation. I also manually checked the website's links, images, navigation and content to make sure they worked correctly.

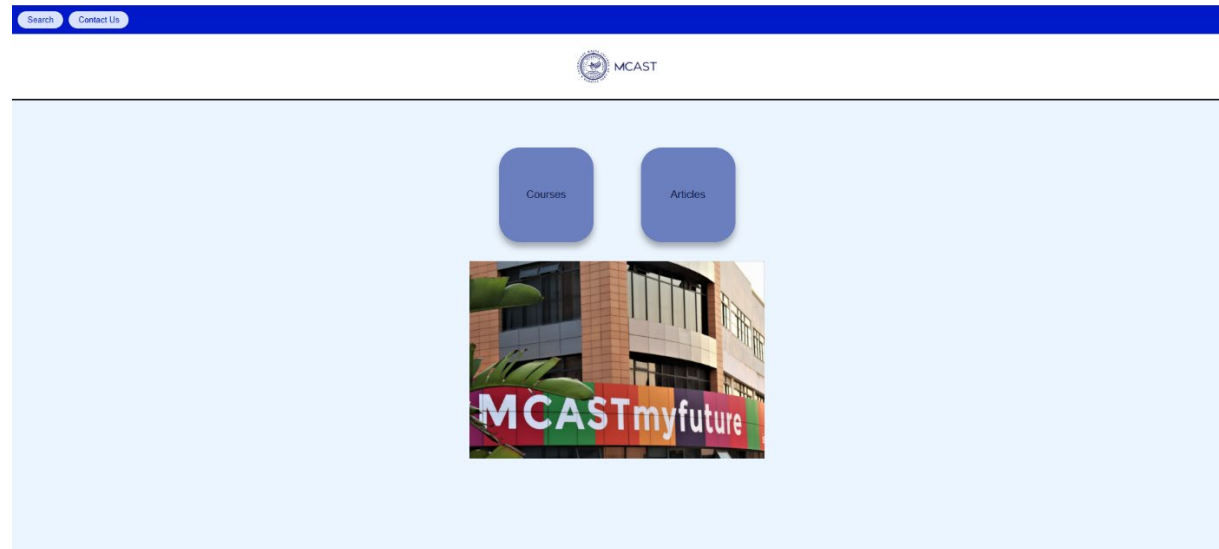
One remaining weakness is responsiveness. My earlier survey showed that **50% of respondents used a mobile phone**, but the current stylesheet does not yet contain responsive media queries. Some fixed dimensions and spacing may therefore be less effective on smaller screens. Accessibility could also be improved through further keyboard-navigation, focus, alternative-text and colour-contrast testing.

If more development time were available, I would create a fully responsive layout, add a functional search and course-filtering feature, and carry out further usability testing with students using different devices. These improvements would make information easier to access and make the website more effective for a wider range of prospective students.

2.Before-and-After Comparison

Improvement 1 - Home Page

Before



After



What was changed

The original homepage contained a basic top bar, MCAST logo, Courses and Articles buttons, and one campus image. The redeveloped homepage contains a complete navigation toolbar, hero banner, introductory information about MCAST, additional images, reasons to study at MCAST, Explore Courses and Contact Us buttons, and a footer with contact information and social-media links.

Why was the change made?

User feedback identified the need for clearer navigation, an improved layout and greater use of images. I therefore redesigned the homepage to provide clearer navigation and more useful information when users first enter the website.

How did it improve the user experience?

Users now have clearer pathways to important sections and can access Home, Contact Us and Articles consistently. The additional headings, images and calls-to-action also make the page easier to understand and visually more engaging.

Improvement 2 – Contact Page

Before



Locations

- Institute for the Creative Arts Mosta Campus Misrah Ghonoq Targa Gap, Mosta MST 1735
- MCAST Main Campus Triq Kordin, Paola, Malta PLA9032
- Gozo Campus J.F. De Chambray Street MCAST, Ghajnsielem Gozo GSM 1053

Telephone Number

- +356 2398 7100

Email Address

- information@mcast.edu.mt



MCAST institute-for-the-creative-arts

After

[Home](#) [Contact Us](#)  [MCAST](#) [Articles](#)

Main Campus Contact

Part-Time Courses Operation

Period	Opening Days	Opening Hours	Contact
All Year	Monday-Friday	8:00-16:00	Visit: mg2malta.com for more info

Contact Information

Main Reception	Student House	General Enquiries
+356 2398 7100	+356 2398 7170	information@mcast.edu.mt

Department Services

Service	Opening Days	Opening Hours	Contact
Admissions and Records Department	Monday-Friday, excluding Public Holidays	8:00-16:00	+356 2398 7888 or mcast7888@mcast.edu.mt
International Students Office	Monday-Friday, excluding Public Holidays	8:00-16:00	MCASTINTapp@mcast.edu.mt
Library, Learning and Resources Centre	Monday-Friday, excluding Public Holidays	8:00-16:00	+356 2398 7500
Career Guidance	Monday-Friday, excluding Public Holidays	8:00-16:00	+356 2398 7135 / 7136 or careerguidance@mcast.edu.mt
Grievance Office	Monday-Friday, excluding Public Holidays	8:00-16:00	sandra.cortis@mcast.edu.mt

Institute Contact Info

Institute	Location	Telephone	Email Address
Institute for Information and Communication Technology	Main Campus, Triq Kordin, Paola, PLA 9032	+356 2398 7250	ict@mcast.edu.mt
Institute of Business, Management and Commerce	Main Campus, Paola	+356 2398 7600	ibmc@mcast.edu.mt
Institute of Applied Science	Main Campus, Triq Kordin, Paola, PLA 9032	+356 2398 7800	ias@mcast.edu.mt
Gozo Campus	J.F. De Chambray Street, Ghajnsielem, Gozo, GSM 1053	+356 2398 7665	gozocampus@mcast.edu.mt

Send us a message for more queries?

Full Name

Email Address

Subject

Message

[Send Message](#)



What was changed

The original Contact page mainly displayed campus locations, a telephone number, an email address and an image. The redeveloped page contains structured tables displaying opening hours, departments, institutes and clearer contact information. A contact form was also added with Full Name, Email Address, Subject and Message fields.

Why was the change made?

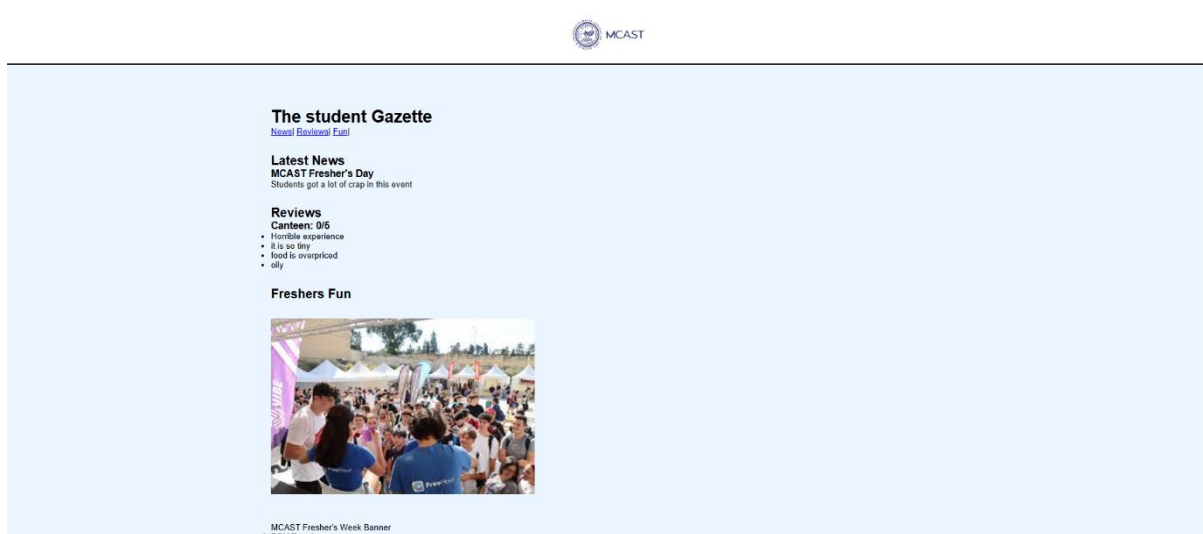
The previous page provided limited information and required users to read through basic lists. The redevelopment was intended to organise contact information more clearly and give users a direct method of preparing an enquiry.

How did it improve the user experience?

Tables make information easier to access, while the contact form provides an obvious method for contacting MCAST. Important information is separated into categories, helping prospective students find the correct department more efficiently.

Improvement 3 – Articles Page

Before



After

MCAST Articles

Latest News

MCAST Canteen Reviews

According to the results of our survey, a significant number of students expressed concerns regarding the management and overall quality of the canteen services at the MCAST Mosta campus.

Canteen Rating: 0/5

- Horrible experience.
- It is too small.
- Food is overpriced.
- The food is oily.



MCAST Canteen at Paola Campus, Updated, 2024

MCAST Freshers Week Activities

Students' experiences during fresher's week

- BOV Running

Canteen Rating: 0/5

- Horrible experience.
- It is too small.
- Food is overpriced.
- The food is oily.



MCAST Canteen at Paola Campus, Updated, 2024

MCAST Freshers Week Activities

Students' experiences during fresher's week

- BOV Running
- MCAST Support
- Collecting Freebies
- Costa Coffee



MCAST Fresher's Week Poster, 2025



Students gathering during Freeflow's interviews

What was changed

Compared with the original submission, the Articles page had a simple Student Gazette layout with basic sections and limited visual content. The redeveloped version has a clearer MCAST Articles heading, separate article sections, more detailed information, photographs and captions. For example, the final page includes a structured MCAST Canteen Reviews section with survey-related information and an image.

Why was the change made?

Feedback indicated that more imagery and an improved layout would make the website more appealing and understandable. The content therefore needed stronger visual organisation.

How did it improve the user experience?

Separating the content into recognisable sections creates a clearer information hierarchy. Relevant photographs provide visual context, while headings help users scan the page and locate the article they are interested in more quickly.

3.Areas for Further Development

1. Creating a Responsive Mobile-Friendly Version

In the future, I could use responsive CSS with media queries so that the navigation, images, text, tables and footer adapt to mobile phones and tablets. This is important because 50% of respondents in my survey stated that they accessed websites using a mobile phone. A responsive layout would prevent content from becoming crowded or difficult to read on smaller screens.

Benefit to the audience: Prospective students would be able to use the website more comfortably from their phones without unnecessary zooming or horizontal scrolling.

2. Functional Search and Course Filtering

A future version could include a working search feature and filters, allowing users to search for courses by level, institute, subject area or full-time/part-time status as more pages are developed. Course information was one of the main reasons respondents stated that they visited the MCAST website, besides accessing the catalogue from the homepage.

Benefit to the audience: Prospective students could find relevant courses more quickly rather than manually searching through large amounts of information.

3. Additional User Testing

Further usability testing could be completed with more prospective students by providing tasks such as locating a department, finding course information, reading an article and completing the contact form.

Benefit to the audience: Testing the website with prospective students would help identify usability problems and allow future versions to better meet their needs.
